> offices, I telephoned Bobby to underline that he should pass this along to Dobrynin only as information, not a public pledge. Bobby, told me that he was then sitting with Dobrynin and had already talked with him.[60]

After his meeting with the ambassador, RFK sent a minute of his conversation to Dean Rusk. These accounts suggest that the Secretary of State and the Attorney General were singing from the same hymn sheet. The statement that the missiles were already being withdrawn, however, was not true.

Most commentators believed that no *quid pro quo* meant no *quid pro quo.*Some historians – such as Barton Bernstein – nevertheless concluded there had been a deal of some sort. In 1980 Bernstein suggested that, on 27 October, Kennedy 'privately offered a hedged promise' to withdraw the Jupiters from Turkey.[61] Towards the end of the 1980s, significant new evidence emerged from US and Soviet sources to more clearly demonstrate that withdrawal of the Jupiters was linked to the withdrawal of the R-12s.[62] For some of Kennedy's critics, the revelations undermined the received wisdom that JFK's steadfastness resolved the crisis.

Ted Sorensen was responsible for posthumously editing the diary of Robert Kennedy that formed the basis for *Thirteen Days*. At the Moscow conference in January 1989 he provided a 'confession' and admitted deliberately falsifying RFK's account to preserve the myth that President Kennedy had not traded the missiles in Cuba for missiles in Turkey. The diary was 'very explicit' that the missiles in Turkey were part of the deal, Sorensen told the Moscow conference, 'but at that time it was still a secret, even on the American side, except for the six of us who had been present at that meeting. So I took it upon myself to edit that out of his diaries.'[63] McGeorge Bundy wrote: 'we misled our colleagues, our countrymen, our successors, and our allies.'[64]

In 1994, evidence from the archives of the Russian Foreign Ministry cast important new light on the meeting between Dobrynin and Kennedy. This corroborated the revelations of Sorensen and Bundy. After their meeting at the Justice Department, the ambassador returned to his embassy and